ગુજરાતી શિક્ષણ સંઘ

Consortium of Gujarati Schools

https://www.gujaratischools.org/

Notes of the BGM held on Sunday 19th May 2024 at Ekta Centre

Members present:

Sonalben R Shah (Chair); Tusharbhai Shah (Vice-Chair); Vijyaben Bhanderi (Secretary); Rekhaben Patel (Treasurer); Jayantbhai Tanna (Immediate Past Chair) **plus** 34 other members as per attached list.

1. Welcome and Apologies

At the start, Jayantbhai explained to the meeting that owing to Sonalben Shah's family circumstances linked to her mother-in-law's poor health, which required continuing care, she wished to give up as Chair of CGS. Jayantbhai persuaded her otherwise and agreed to take over the task of organising and managing the BGM. He put together all reports and BGM procedures assisted by the Secretary.

Jayantbhai then welcomed and thanked all members present.

Apologies were received from Rekhaben Shah of MYCA; CB Patel; Jayrajbhai Bhadaranwala and Kantibhai Nagda of NCGO; Shobhaben Joshi (Leicester); Chetanaben Bhatt-Shah (Oldham); Himaben Pabari (Pandav VS) and Bhavikbhai Hirani (Willesden Mandir).

2. Notes of the last meeting – 22nd May 2022 (circulated in advance via email)

Jayantbhai shared the Notes of the last BGM and went through them briefly.

3. Matters arising

(a) Jayantbhai explained Organisational Membership is £25 **per school** and Individual Membership is to £10 per member both for two years. Jayantbhai requested Organisations to pay their subscriptions. He also requested all teachers to become Individual Members by paying £10.

(b) School Information Forms - We received only three completed forms in 2023 and only two for 2024. Vijyaben requested all Gujarati schools to complete and return these forms by the stated deadline, together with leaflet about the schools.

(c) CGS Website www.gujaratischools.org

Jayantbhai pointed out that the website includes very useful information, resources for both teachers and parents, past GCSE papers, which can be downloaded, etc.

(d) Examination Centres

- Jayantbhai informed the meeting about the tremendous difficulties experienced by parents in finding examination centres for their children's GCSE and A Level Gujarati examination entries.
- We therefore needed to think about having one of our own centres for the future.
- Alpeshbhai Patel from BAPS centre stated they were happy to enter external students for GCSE provided applications were made by the deadline date and approved by the candidate's own Gujarati teachers.

(e) Teachers Training

- GCSE candidates do not always get the higher marks in their Speaking tests because teacher examiners do not always ask a fuller range of questions to get the best out of the candidates. It was agreed that we arrange appropriate training for teachers.
- It was also a huge concern that very few pupils are opting to take A Level Gujarati courses.
- Alpeshbhai of BAPS expressed concern about new teachers who needed some training. Jayantbhai agreed that the new committee would organise training in these areas.

4. Report for 2022 – 2024 (circulated in advance via email)

Sonalben shared the biennial Report for 2022-2024 on screen. CGS received 14 Individual and 10 Organisational memberships. For several reasons CGS was not able to organise training for teachers as planned. The number of candidates for GCSE Gujarati had slightly improved from previous year. Although CGS arranged classes for A level students with subsidised fees, sadly, only three students accepted offer and only two entered for the A level exam in 2024.

Visit to schools were planned but could not be made as times and dates were not convenient to all.

Jayantbhai thanked Sonalben for her Report.

5. Treasurer's Report (circulated in advance via email)

- The CGS financial Statement was shared on the screen by our Treasurer, Rekhaben Patel, for 2022-2024.
- S**he** explained that our balance was a healthy amount of £2885 as of 31st March 2024.
- The income was from Individual and Organisational members and from fees received for three A level candidates.
- As no training or other events were organised, there was no Expenditure.

6. Proposed changes to the Rules of CGS (circulated in advance via email)

Jayantbhai shared Rules of the CGS on screen and went through the proposed changes.

- The BGM agreed to have additional posts for Vice Chairs for the Midlands and the Northwest.
- The BGM agreed that Nomination for any post shall be by self-nomination in writing on a prescribed form and signed by the candidate.
- The BGM agreed to do away with two joint signatures to any **one** signature of the three officers – Chair, Secretary and Treasurer.
- CGS would also be able to apply for a Debit card that would help with payments and references.
- The latest bank statement of the CGS Bank Account should be presented at every committee meeting.
- Transactions will be live on their mobile apps, which they could easily check and confirm with each other.

7. Presentations from Gujarati schools

Representatives from various Gujarati Schools shared their presentations on the screen as follows:

(a) Pandav Vidhya Shala - Jatinbhai Shah presented information about their school's activities with special emphasis on teaching the alphabet to Year 1 students using simple words and also engaging all students in the schools.

(b) SKLPC Saturday School - Jeetendrabhai Vagjiani talked about various activities undertaken by SKLPC Saturday School. Jasuben Jesani showed the Level 1, 2 and 3 textbooks published by the school. She explained how teachers taught Gujarati to younger children by using phonics. 13 students sat for GCSE in 2023 and achieved grades ranging from 9 to 6.

(c) OAUK - Sonalben Shah went through the activities of the Northwest Area Gujarati classes using technology to prepare resources. Two students sat for GCSE in 2023 and achieved grades 8 and 5. In the North Area, 4 students sat for GCSE in 2023 and achieved grades ranging from 8 to 4. OAUK West area Gujarati classes are held in the new venue.

(d) SKSS Mandir in Willesden - Gopalbhai Hirani - The Gujarati School is in purpose-built classrooms. They have classes for very young children also. It is a GCSE Examination Centre where external students are also accepted. In 2023, 18 students from Mandir sat for GCSE and achieved good grades.

(e) MYCA - Mandhata Youth and Community - Students are taught Gujarati poems and different events are organised where they have the opportunity to present poems and plays.

8. Jayantbhai welcomed NCGO President, Vimaljibhai Odedra and Committee Member, Chandrakantbhai Mehta.

Vimaljibhai Odedra thanked CGS for inviting him. He praised the efforts that CGS had made to keep Gujarati alive with our younger generation. He was happy to see CGS training teachers of Gujarati language and helping to increase the number of students leaning Gujarati. CGS information is also being published in the NCGO newsletter.

9. Election of the new CGS Committee for 2024 - 2026

CGS received o**ne** nominations for **each of** the posts - Chair, Secretary and Treasurer as follows:

Jayantbhai Tanna (Chair) Vijyaben Bhanderi (Secretary) Rekhaben Patel (Treasurer)

As there were no other candidates for these posts, all the above three were elected unanimously.

For the Vice Chair Midlands, a nomination was received from Shobhaben Joshi and for the Vice Chair Northwest, a nomination was received from Chetanaben Bhatt-Shah. Both were elected unanimously.

The following were elected as Committee Members

Dipaben Chhatralia	Hasvinaben Shah	Himaben Pabari
Jatinbhai Shah	Prafulaben Shah	Ritaben Kamdar
Ritaben Patel	Tusharbhai Shah	Veljibhai Vekaria

As per Rules of CGS Sonalben Shah would serve as the Immediate Past Chair to ensure continuity.

10. Vote of Thanks & Close

Sonalben thanked the past committee members for their support during 2022-2024. Jayantbhai thanked Ekta Centre for the hire of premises, guests and all those who attended the meeting. He also thanked Hasvinaben, Sonalben, Radhaben, Vijyaben and Rekhaben Patel for providing snacks and refreshments.

The meeting closed at approximately at 5.00 pm.

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Chair Secretary Date

Attendance - Biennial Meeting – 29th May 2024

No.	Forename	Organisation
1.	Hasvinaben Shah	CGS Committee Member & Shishukunj - Finchley Kendra
2.	Prafulaben Shah	CGS Committee Member & Oshwal Association UK
3.	Radhaben Patel	CGS Committee Member
4.	Ritaben Kamdar	CGS Committee Member & Alperton Community School
5.	Tusharbhai Shah	CGS Vice-Chair - Oshwal Association UK
6.	Veljibhai Vekaria	CGS Committee Member & Hindu Forum of Britain
7.	Alpeshbhai Patel	Neasden - BAPS Swaminarayan Mandir, National Lead
8.	Kalpana Acharya	Gujarati Teacher
9.	Rasilaben Shah	Gujarati Teacher
10.	Sulochana Savdas	Milton Keynes - Hindu Association - Co-ordinator
11.	Chetanaben Lalji	Milton Keynes - Hindu Association - Gujarati Teacher
12.	Nimaben Patel	Milton Keynes - Hindu Association - Gujarati Teacher
13.	Chandrakant Mehta	Hayes - NCGO & Navnat Vanik Association - Guest
14.	Vimaljibhai Odedra	NCGO President - Guest
15.	Mahendrabhai Jadeja	London West - OAUK West Area Shakti Centre Gujarati School
16.	Maheshbhai Shah	London West - OAUK West Area Shakti Centre Gujarati School
17.	Shobhaben Shah	London West - OAUK West Area Shakti Centre Gujarati School
18.	Kantaben Shah	OCR - Past GCSE Examiner
19.	Ritaben Patel	Bushey - Pandav Vidhya Shala - Head of Curriculum
20.	Jatinbhai Shah	Bushey - Pandav Vidhya Shala - Head of Curriculum
21.	Bhavnaben Depala	London North - Shishukunj - Mill Hill Kendra
22.	Hinaben Depala	London North - Shishukunj - Mill Hill Kendra
23.	Hinaben Shah	London North - Shishukunj - Mill Hill Kendra
24.	Pritiben Shah	London North - Shishukunj - Mill Hill Kendra
25.	Rashmiben Ganatra	London North - Shishukunj - Mill Hill Kendra
26.	Hansaben Khetani	Stanmore - SKLPC Saturday School - Advisor
27.	Jeetendrabhai Vaghjiani	Stanmore - SKLPC Saturday School – Co-ordinator
28.	Hetalben Kerai	Stanmore - SKLPC Saturday School - Teacher
29.	Jasuben Jesani	Stanmore - SKLPC Saturday School – Head Teacher
30.	Kanchanben Shah	Kenton - SKSS Kenton Gujarati School - Gujarati Teacher
31.	Premjibhai Bhudia	Willesden - SKSS Temple Gujarati School - Deputy Head
32.	Gopalbhai Hirani	Willesden - SKSS Temple Gujarati School
33.	Lalitaben Patel	Volunteer
34.	Jyotsnaben Patel	Gujarati Teacher